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DXB best in Asia-Pacific, regional air connectivity

DUBAI

Dubai International (DXB) has maintained its position as the leading airport in the Airports Council International (ACI's) 2024 Air Connectivity Ranking for the Asia-Pacific and Middle East. The airport currently serves more than 265 destinations across six continents, reinforcing its contribution to global trade, tourism, and the creation of sustainable economic opportunities. Paul Griffiths, CEO of Dubai Airports, said, "Connectivity is the cornerstone of relevance in global aviation, and we are pleased to see DXB recognised once again as the region's leading hub in ACI's 2024 Air Connectivity Ranking. What sets DXB apart is not only the scale of our network, but the consistency and quality of the connections the airport provides."

**Delivered with precision**  
He added, "But connectivity at this level only matters if it is delivered with precision. Our strength lies in combining reach with efficiency, ensuring fast, seamless and secure journeys for tens of millions of guests each year. This recognition reflects the oneDXB spirit — a shared commitment of our airline partners, broader airport community and city of Dubai. Together, we are shaping a model of airport connectivity that is agile, guest-focused and economically significant, not just for the region but for the world." — WAM

# 1 dead, 48 hurt as crowd fired upon at Gaza's US-run aid site

ISRAEL DENIES ROLE; UN SLAMS NEW FOOD AID DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM IN RAFAH

DEIR AL BALAH

At least one Palestinian was killed and 48 others wounded when a crowd was fired upon while overrunning a new aid distribution site in the Gaza Strip set up by an Israeli and US-backed foundation, Gaza's Health Ministry said yesterday. Crowds of Palestinians on Tuesday broke through fences around the distribution site where thousands had massed. An Associated Press journalist heard Israeli tank and gun fire, and saw a military helicopter firing flares. It was not yet known whether the death and injuries were caused by Israeli forces, private contractors or others. The foundation said its military contractors had not fired on the crowd but "fell back" before resuming aid operations. Israel said its troops nearby had fired warning shots but not at the crowd.

**Chaos at new aid hub**  
The distribution hub outside Gaza's southernmost city of Rafah was opened the day before by the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation (GHF), which has been slated by Israel to take over aid operations. The UN and other humanitarian organisations have rejected the new system, saying it won't be able to meet the needs of Gaza's 2.3 million people and allows Israel to use food to control the population. They have also warned of the risk of friction between Israeli troops and people seeking supplies. Palestinians have become desperate for food after nearly



Palestinians carry boxes containing food and humanitarian aid packages delivered by the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation, in Rafah. AP

**What we saw yesterday is a very clear example of the dangers of distributing food under [these] circumstances. [The new system is] exposing people to death and injury when they have faced 19 months of this brutal war."**

**Ajith Sunghay** | Head of the UN Human Rights Office for the Palestinian territories

three months of Israeli border closures pushed Gaza to the brink of famine. "What we saw yesterday is a very clear example of the dangers of distributing food under (these) circumstances," Ajith Sunghay, head of the UN Human Rights Office for the Palestinian territories, told reporters in Geneva. He said the new system is "exposing people to death and injury when they have faced 19 months of this brutal war." Israel said it helped establish

the new aid mechanism to prevent Hamas from siphoning off supplies, but it has provided no evidence of systematic diversion and UN agencies say they have mechanisms in place to prevent it while delivering aid to all parts of the territory. GHF says it has established four hubs, two of which have begun operating in the now mostly uninhabited southern city of Rafah. They are guarded by private security contractors and have chain-link fences channelling Palestinians into what resemble military bases surrounded by large sand berms. — AP

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